

Lydia Manikonda

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS	Assistant Professor, Wellington Developmental Teaching Chair Lally School of Management, Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, Troy, NY	Fall 2019 – <i>Present</i>
EDUCATION	Ph.D. Computer Science, Arizona State University, Tempe, Arizona Advisor: <i>Prof. Subbarao Kambhampati (rakaposhi.eas.asu.edu)</i> M.S. Computer Science and Engineering, International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad, India B.Tech (Hons) Computer Science and Engineering, International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad, India	2019 2012 2009
CURRENT FUNDED AWARDS	1. NSF IUCRC – Center for Research toward Advancing Financial Technologies (CRAFT). Pilot Grant: PromptShield: A Testing Framework for GenAI-related Data Leaks in FinTech. L. Manikonda (PI). \$30,000. 06/01/2026 to 12/01/2026. 2. Google.org via Empire AI. A Novel Educational Assessment Framework for Enhancing Critical Thinking and Self-Efficacy via Generative AI Integration. L. Manikonda (PI), M. Si (Co-PI), Kristin Bennett (Co-PI), Oshani Seneviratne (Co-PI). \$100,000. 08/01/2025 to 06/30/2026. 3. The Louis & Hortense Rubin Community Fellows Program. An Artificial Intelligence (AI) Framework to address Unemployment and Mental Health issues. L. Manikonda (PI). \$11,000. 4. NSF IUCRC – Center for Research toward Advancing Financial Technologies (CRAFT). Full Grant: High Dimensional Portfolio Design and Optimization using an Explainable Ensemble Learning Framework. L. Manikonda (PI), C. Edirisinghe (Co-PI). \$100,000. 06/01/2022 to 05/31/2023.	
REFEREED JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS	[1] Tyra Girdwood, and Lydia Manikonda “Navigating artificial intelligence in qualitative research: ethical and practical considerations from concept to publication”, <i>Frontiers in Research Metrics and Analytics</i>, 2026. [2] Mee Young Um, Lydia Manikonda, Doncy Eapen, Kristin Ferguson, Diane Santa Maria, Sarah Narendorf, Robin Petering, Anamika Barman-Adhikari, Hsun-Ta Hsu, “Predicting Intimate Partner Violence Perpetration among Young Adults Experiencing Homelessness in Seven U.S. Cities Using Interpretable Machine Learning”, <i>Journal of Interpersonal Violence</i>, 2025 . [3] Lydia Manikonda, Dorit Nevo, Benjamin D. Horne, Clare Arrington, and Sibel Adali, “The Reasoning behind Fake News Assessments: A Linguistic Analysis”, <i>AIS Transactions on Human-Computer Interaction</i>, 2022. [4] Niharika Jain, Alberto Olmo, Sailik Sengupta, Lydia Manikonda, Subbarao Kambhampati, “Imperfect ImaGANation: Implications of GANs Exacerbating Biases on Facial Data”, <i>Artificial Intelligence (AIJ) Journal</i>, 2021. [5] Benjamin D. Horne, Dorit Nevo, Sibel Adali, Lydia Manikonda, and Clare Arrington, “Tailoring Heuristics and Timing AI Interventions for Supporting News Veracity Assessments”, <i>Computers in Human Behavior Reports</i>, 2020.	

- [6] **Lydia Manikonda**, Tathagata Chakraborti, Kartik Talamadupula, Subbarao Kambhampati, “Herd-
ing the Crowd: Using Automated Planning for Better Crowdsourced Planning”, *Human Computa-
tion Journal*, 2017.
- [7] Shashi Shekhar, KwangSoo Yang, Venkata M.V. Gunturi, **Lydia Manikonda**, Dev Oliver, Xun
Zhou, Betsy George, Sangho Kim, Jeffrey M. R. Wolff, Qingsong Lu, “Experiences with Evacuation
Route Planning Algorithms”, *International Journal of Geographical Information Science (IJGIS)*,
2012.
- [8] Munira, Sirajam, **Lydia Manikonda**, “The Day My Chatbot Changed: Characterizing the Mental
Health Impacts of Social AI App Updates via Negative User Reviews”, *In Companion Publication
of the 2026 18th ACM Web Science Conference*, pp. 58-61. 2026.
- [9] **Lydia Manikonda**, Antti Hämäläinen, Miriam Gräf and David Rochholz, “Competitive Spillovers
from AI Versioning: Evidence from AI Platform App Reviews”, *In Proceedings of the International
Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)*, 2025
- [10] Zeleke, Brook, Amish Soni, **Lydia Manikonda**, “Human or GenAI? Characterizing the Linguistic
Differences between Human-Written and LLM-Generated Text”, *In Companion Publication of the
17th ACM Web Science Conference 2025*, pp. 34-37. 2025.
- [11] Sebastian, Joseph, Khadija Ali Vakeel, **Lydia Manikonda**, and T. Ravichandran. “Navigating Pri-
vacy and Engagement in the Digital Age”, *In Companion Publication of the 17th ACM Web Science
Conference*, pp. 30-33. 2025
- [12] Yuanyuan Liu, T. Ravichandran, **Lydia Manikonda** “Can Emotional Cues Substitute for Sharing
Privacy Compromising Personal Information: An Empirical Exploration in Medical Crowdfunding”,
European Conference on Information Systems (ECIS), 2025
- [13] Joseph Sebastian, Khadija Ali Vakheel, **Lydia Manikonda**, T.Ravichandran “Impact of Cognitive
Absorption and Privacy Concerns on Online Platforms”, *TREO, International Conference on Infor-
mation Systems (ICIS)*, 2024
- [14] Joseph Sebastian, **Lydia Manikonda** “Exploring the Role of Temporal Privacy in Intelligent Per-
sonal Assistants”, *TREO, International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)*, 2023
- [15] Yelena Mejova¹, **Lydia Manikonda**¹ “Comfort Foods and Community Connectedness: Investi-
gating Diet Change during COVID-19 using YouTube Videos on Twitter”, *In Proceedings of the
International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media*, vol. 17, pp. 602-613. 2023.
- [16] Joseph Sebastian, **Lydia Manikonda**, “Investigating Privacy Paradox in the Context of Voice-based
AI Systems”, *TREO, Americas Conference on Information Systems (AMCIS)*, 2022.
- [17] **Lydia Manikonda**, Mee Young Umm, and Rui Fan, “Shift of User Attitudes about Anti-Asian Hate
on Reddit Before and During COVID-19”, *In Proceedings of the 14th ACM Web Science Conference
2022* (pp. 364-369).
- [18] Nay Aungwin Zaw, **Lydia Manikonda**, “Linguistic Analysis of User Disclosures about Smoking
Addiction during COVID-19 via Reddit”, *Data Challenge at ICWSM*, 2022
- [19] Yufei Wu, Thilanka Munasinghe, **Lydia Manikonda**, and Oshani Seneviratne, “Data-driven Anal-
ysis of Remote Work in China during the COVID-19 Pandemic”, *In Proceedings of the 55th Hawaii
International Conference on System Sciences*, 2022
- [20] Niharika Jain, Alberto Olmo, Sailik Sengupta, **Lydia Manikonda**, Subbarao Kambhampati, “Im-
perfect ImaGANation: Implications of GANs Exacerbating Biases on Facial Data”, *SDG Workshop,
ICLR*, 2021
- [21] Brendan Cunha, **Lydia Manikonda**, “An RNN-based Classifier to detect Misinformation in News
Articles”, *ICWSM Data Challenge: Safety*, 2020.
- [22] **Lydia Manikonda**, Shailesh Divey, “Reddit: A Novel Online Financial Consultancy”, *The AAAI-20
Workshop on Knowledge Discovery from Unstructured Data in Financial Services (KDF)*, 2020.

- [23] **Lydia Manikonda**, Subbarao Kambhampati, “Tweeting AI: Perceptions of Lay vs Expert Twitterati”, In *Proceedings of The International Conference on Weblogs and Social Media (ICWSM)*, 2018.
- [24] Nur Kamarudin, Vineeth Rakesh, Ghazaleh Beigi, **Lydia Manikonda**, Huan Liu, “A Study of Reddit – Users Response to Rape”, *ASONAM*, 2018.
- [25] **Lydia Manikonda**, Ghazaleh Beigi, Huan Liu, Subbarao Kambhampati, “#metoo through the Lens of Social Media”, In *International conference on social computing, behavioral-cultural modeling and prediction and behavior representation in modeling and simulation 2018 (pp. 104-110)*. Cham: Springer International Publishing.
- [26] **Lydia Manikonda**, Aditya Deotale, Subbarao Kambhampati, “What’s up with Privacy?: User Preferences and Privacy Concerns in Intelligent Personal Assistants”, In *Proceedings of AAAI/ACM Conference on Artificial Intelligence, Ethics, and Society*, 2018
- [27] **Lydia Manikonda**, Shirin Sohrabi, Biplav Srivastava, Kartik Talamadupula, Subbarao Kambhampati, “Extracting Incomplete Planning Action Models from Unstructured Social Media Data to Support Decision Making”, *Workshop on Knowledge Engineering for Planning and Scheduling, ICAPS*, 2017
- [28] **Lydia Manikonda**, Munmun De Choudhury, “Modeling and Understanding Visual Attributes of Mental Health Disclosures in Social Media”, *ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)*, 2017
- [29] Ece Kamar, **Lydia Manikonda**, “Complementing the Execution of AI Systems with Human Computation”, *AAAI Workshop on Crowdsourcing, Deep Learning and Artificial Intelligence Agents*, 2017
- [30] **Lydia Manikonda**, Vamsi Meduri, Subbarao Kambhampati, “Tweeting the Mind and Instagramming the Heart: Exploring Differentiated Content Sharing on Social Media”, In *Proceedings of The International Conference on Weblogs and Social Media (ICWSM)*, 2016
- [31] **Lydia Manikonda**, Heather Pon-Barry, Subbarao Kambhampati, Eric Hekler, David W. McDonald, “Venting Weight: Analyzing the Discourse of an Online Weight Loss Forum”, *The 3rd International Workshop on the World Wide Web and Population Health Intelligence (AAAI-W3PHI)*, 2016
- [32] **Lydia Manikonda**, Tathagata chakraborti, Sushovan De, Kartik Talamadupula, Subbarao Kambhampati, “AI-MIX: How a Planner Can Help Guide Humans Towards a Better Crowdsourced Plan”, In *Proceedings of Conference on Human Computation & Crowdsourcing (HCOMP)*, 2014.
- [33] Yuheng Hu, **Lydia Manikonda**, Subbarao Kambhampati, “What We Instagram: A First Analysis of Instagram Photo Content and Users”, In *Proceedings of The International Conference on Weblogs and Social Media (ICWSM)*, 2014 [*Featured on Wired, abcnews*]
- [34] **Lydia Manikonda**, Usha Kumar, Shashi Shekhar, “A Facebook Application for Improving Disaster Management”, *Grace Hopper Conference for Women in Computing*, 2012.
- [35] Ashish Garg, **Lydia Manikonda**, Shashank Kumar, Vikrant Krishna, Shyam Boriah, Michael Steinbach, Vipin Kumar, Durga Toshniwal, Christopher Potter, Steven Klooster, “A Model-Free Time Series Segmentation Approach for Land Cover Change Detection”, *NASA Conference on Intelligent Data Understanding (CIDU)*, 2011.
- [36] **Lydia Manikonda**, Raghvendra Mall, Vikram Pudi, Raghunath Rao, “Mining Nutrition Survey Data”, *IEEE Symposium on Computational Intelligence and Data Mining*, Paris, France, April 2011.
- [37] **Lydia Manikonda**, Ashish Mangalampalli, Vikram Pudi, “UACI: Uncertain Associative Classifier for Object Class Identification”, *The 25th International Conference of Image and Vision Computing*, New Zealand, November 2010.
- [38] **Lydia Manikonda**, Annu Tuli, Vikram Pudi, “ProMax: A Profit Maximizing Recommendation System for Market Baskets”, *SIGAI Workshop on Emerging Research Trends in AI*, 2010.

PATENTS	[39] Lydia Manikonda, Shirin Sohrabi, Biplav Srivastava, Kartik Talamadupula, “Learning personalized actionable domain models” – US Patent App. 15/475,551, 2018. [40] Lydia Manikonda, Shirin Sohrabi, Biplav Srivastava, Kartik Talamadupula, “Learning Personalized Actionable Domain Models” Pub.No: US 2018/0285770 A1, Pub.Date: Oct.4,2018. [41] Lydia Manikonda, Shirin Sohrabi, Biplav Srivastava, Kartik Talamadupula, Anton Riabov, Deepak Turaga, “Autonomous learning of actionable models from unstructured data” Pub.No: US 2018/0218270 A1, Pub.Date: Aug.2, 2018.
BOOK CHAPTERS	[42] Nur Shazwani Kamarudin, Ghazaleh Beigi, Lydia Manikonda, Huan Liu, “Social Media for Mental Health: Data, Methods, and Findings”, Open Source Intelligence and Cyber Crime (Social Media Analytics), 195-220, Springer Link, 1st ed. 2020.
GRANTS NOT SELECTED FOR FUNDING	• NSF – CAREER: Goal-Centric Decision-Making Tools and Education to Support Addiction Recovery. \$886,673. • New York State Pollution Prevention Institute, Research & Development Program. Sunwise: Empowering Solar Solutions for Homes and Small Businesses through Data-Centric AI. \$100,000. • Robert Wood Johnson Foundation (RWJF) – Research on Diet-Related Health Data Access Awards 2024. Mining Associations between Diet, Prescriptions and Health Iniquities in the though Advanced AI techniques. Only data access. • NSF – CAREER: Goal-Centric Decision-Making Tools and Education to Support Addiction Recovery. \$869,138. 2023. • NSF IUCRC – Center for Research toward Advancing Financial Technologies (CRAFT). Full Grant: A Neural embedding-based Framework to Analyze Fintech-related Social Media Discussions. \$100,000. 2023. • NSF – Full proposal: Classroom with AI assistant. \$600,000. 2021. • DARPA – Full proposal: eMPiRIC: Modeling Population Response to Information Campaigns. \$7,004,240. 2021.
AWARDS AND NOTABLE RECOGNITIONS	• Recipient of 2026 Excellence in Teaching Award for Undergraduate Programs from from Lally School of Management, RPI. • Our work titled “The Impact of Social AI Chatbots on Mental Health of Users” received the Best Poster Award at Conference on Health IT and Analytics (CHITA) 2026. • Our team received the Outstanding Performance Award at the ICIS 2025 Paper-a-thon. • Awarded the Wellington Developmental Teaching Chair position at RPI. • Best Senior Program Committee Member AAAI ICWSM 2025. • RPI’s Board of Trustees Celebration of Faculty Achievement Award – December 2022, 2025. • Best reviewer award AAAI ICWSM 2019. • People’s Choice award for Best Demonstration, AAAI ICAPS 2014. • Recipient of Anita Borg Institute Scholarship 2015, 2011. • Full travel support to attend Doctoral Consortium at ICAPS-2014, HCOMP-2014. • Recipient of University Graduate Fellowship Award for Fall-2013, Spring-2014 and Summer-2014, Arizona State University. • Google-India Woman in Engineering Award 2011. • Listed in the Dean’s Merit List at IIIT-H for the academic performance in Fall-2007, Spring-2008. • Recipient of Special Mention Award-2009 from IIIT-H for organizing research activities from 2007-2009.
WORKSHOPS	[43] Organizer/Chair – <i>Human-GenAI Interactions: Shaping the Future of Web Science</i> , ACM Web-Science 2025, New Jersey, USA (https://sites.google.com/view/websci-hgenai-2025/). [44] Organizer/Chair – <i>Scientific Discovery with AI</i> Diversity Series Workshop at AAAI-2021 (https://sites.google.com/view/ai4be)

ADVISING

- **Current Doctoral Students:** Sirajam Munira
- **Current Masters and Undergrad Students:** Priscilla Wong, Carina Liu, Erin Chen
- **Past RCOS Undergraduates** Russell Harter, Ritika Brahmadesam, Kalvin Ramiah, Yashas Balaji, Pranav Rana, Noah Taylor
- **Past RPI-STEP program Students** Julieta Gil-Marin
- **Past:** (PhD) Joseph Sebastian, Sareh Ahmadi (Virginia Tech); (UG/MS) Joshue Jaquinet, Samir Gupte, Noah Taylor, Sophia Mazzariello, Brook Zeleke, Ritika Brahmadesam, Amish Soni, Noah Kader, Nay Zaw Aung Win, Shuhan Li, Bradley Morton, Shailesh Divey, Joshua Graham, Junxiong Tang, Aditya Deotale, Cameron Dudley

SERVICE

Internal at RPI

- **Incoming Chair** Faculty Senate Curriculum Committee (FSCC) *Fall 2026 onwards*
Details about the curriculum committee can be found here: <https://provost.rpi.edu/faculty-resources/faculty-senate/faculty-senate-constitution>
- **Chair** Masters' Scholars Research Program (MSRP) Committee *Fall 2023 - present*
Oversee different duties including – soliciting research projects from the faculty and applications from students; screening the student applications and match the accepted applicants with faculty; track progress and provide yearly updates to the Dean and Provost on behalf of the MSRP committee.
- **Committee Member** Strategic Envisioning Committee *Fall 2024 - Summer 2025*
- **Committee Member** RPI Welcome and Inclusive Committee *Fall 2024 - Summer 2025*
- **Committee Member** Lally MS/MBA Admissions Committee *Fall 2020 - Summer 2022*

External

- Served on **National Science Foundation** panels to evaluate proposals.
- **Journal Reviewer** – *Current* Information Systems Research (ISR), MIS Quarterly (MISQ), ACM Transactions on the Web (TWEB), ACM Transactions on Social Computing (TSC), ACM Transactions on Internet Technology (TOIT), Computers in Human Behavior Reports (CHBR)
- **Senior Program Committee member** – *Current* ICWSM, WebScience
- **Program Committee member** – *Past* WebConf, NAACL-HLT, ACL, ASONAM, SDM
- **Data Analyst** for IJCAI 2016
- **Volunteer Map Editor** with USGS

INVITED TALKS, PRESENTATIONS AND MEDIA COVERAGE

- “The Impact of Social AI Chatbots on Mental Health of Users” **Poster presentation** at Conference on Health IT and Analytics (CHITA) 2026.
- “Designing for Humanity: AI’s Limits, Mental Health & Governance”, **Invited Talk**, Maxwell School of Public Policy, Syracuse University, NY.
- I was **invited to be on a panel** titled “AI in the Workplace” by Times Union’s Women@Work April Meeting. More details here (<https://www.timesunion.com/business/article/photos-women-work-breakfast-for-ph>).
- “The Pursuit of AI: Deploying AI Systems in the Wild”, **Invited Talk at AI, Ethics and Law Seminar Lecture**, School of Law, Syracuse University, NY.
- **Invited speaker** for a Mathematical Science Seminar at Houghton College, NY March 2025.
- **Invited speaker** for workshop titled “Causality and Machine Learning/AI” at Virginia Tech <https://kohl.aaec.vt.edu/events/ai.html>, held on November 2nd 2024

- **Invited panelist** for a panel titled “Capital Region Faculty Panel: Safe, Secure, Equitable and Effective AI” at Capital Region Artificial Intelligence Day, SUNY Albany 2024.
- “The Pursuit of AI and the Future of Health”, **Plenary Talk**, 24th Biennial Conference, ACMS, Iowa.
- “Human-AI Collaboration in the New Age of AI”, **Invited Talk**, IIIT-Hyderabad, Hyderabad.
- Seeking a Moral Compass in the Digital Age ([URL](#))
- Discussing COVID-19 and Unemployment on Spectrum News ([URL](#))
- "Why Not Change the World?" **RPI Podcast on Social Media and Artificial Intelligence** ([URL](#))
- **Twelve Christian Women in Science You Should Know** ([URL](#)) by Christianity Today
- “Instagram and Mental Health”, Data and Society, NYC.
- AI and Machine Learning in the context of Privacy – State Press – Arizona State University ([URL](#))
- The Best of the Physics arXiv – MIT Technology Review ([URL](#))
- Article on AI expertise and Twitter – Network World ([URL](#))
- Write up on our Instagram research – ABC news ([URL](#))
- Article on our Instagram research – Wired ([URL](#))

PREVIOUS RESEARCH & EMPLOYMENT EXPERIENCE	Course Instructor – CSE 494/598 Information Retrieval , Arizona State University, Tempe, AZ	Spring 2016
	Research Intern , IBM T. J. Watson Research Center, Yorktown Heights, NY	Summer 2016
	Research Intern , Microsoft Research, Redmond, WA	Summer 2015
	Research Engineer , Kyungpook National University, Daegu, South Korea	Summer 2012
	Research Intern , University of Minnesota, Twin Cities, MN	January 2011 – December 2011
	Research Intern , University of Sydney, Sydney, Australia	Summer 2008
	Research Assistant • Arizona State University, Tempe, AZ • IIIT-Hyderabad, Hyderabad, India	Fall 2013 – Summer 2019 Fall 2008 – Fall 2010
	ACM, AIS, AAAI	
PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS		
OUTSIDE ACTIVITIES	None to report	